

John Terry

Intermediate Team Faculty

Mary, Star of the Sea School

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Syllabus: 2026-2027 Grade 5 Science

Mary, Star of the Sea School Mission

Nurture, Unite, Inspire. We are committed to nurturing each child's curiosity, uniting our classroom in respect and collaboration, and inspiring every student to grow in knowledge, faith, and wonder for the world around them.

2026-2027 Essential Question

"How can I model kindness, fairness, and humility like Jesus?"

Welcome to Grade 5! This syllabus is intended to help you, the student, develop a greater understanding of what we will cover, what is expected of you, and what you can expect from me.

Schoolwide Learning Expectations (SLEs): Self-Aware, Confident Individuals; Teachable Life-Long Learners; Active Christians; Responsible Citizens

Living Our NUI Mission

A supportive environment is essential for student growth and achievement. Students are expected to act respectfully towards other students and to respond to each other's ideas and work with thoughtful comments, positive encouragement, and constructive feedback. Students are expected to be attentive, to work diligently during class, and to follow all classroom rules and directions.

Science Course Overview:

My goal for Science is that students build confidence and mastery through study and hands-on labs and experiments. The three main areas of instruction are Life Science, Earth Science, and Physical Science. Lessons include standards-based content with inquiry-based activities.

The Scientific Method will be a focus of our learning. Students will be provided with hands-on experiences to explore each lesson concept and will formulate questions that can be answered through investigations.

TEXTBOOK:

- HMH Into Science (Science)

SCIENCE GRADING POLICY:

- 30% Tests
- 30% Classwork and Participation
- 20% Quizzes
- 20% Homework

*Parents, please note: You will have access to my electronic gradebook via your Beehively account, which will be a primary method of communicating your child's academic performance. It will be assumed that you have seen all grades and missing assignments that are entered in Beehively.

CURRICULUM — Grade 5 Science

- Quarter 1: Engineering and Technology — identifying problems, improving technology, engineering, design process. Begin Unit 2 Matter — measuring mass and volume, evidence of matter, particles.
- Quarter 2: Finish Unit 2 Matter — properties of matter, how heat affects matter, matter can change, conservation of matter. Begin Unit 3 Energy in Organisms — plants use energy and matter, what plants need to grow, how organisms make food, animal energy, energy moving between organisms.
- Quarter 3: Energy and Matter in Ecosystems — how organisms interact in ecosystems, environment effects, balance in an ecosystem, introduced and invasive species, food webs and food chains, competition in an ecosystem.
- Quarter 4: Earth Interactions and Resources — Earth materials form systems, interactions of systems shape landforms, Earth's major systems, natural events, the water cycle, water stores heat, Earth's resources and human activities.

HOMEWORK POLICY:

Homework that is given will not be for students to explore new concepts. Homework will strictly be to reinforce concepts that have already been taught in class, including research for projects. It is used as more of a "completion" grade.

Your children's teachers will work together to ensure that the students receive a balanced homework regime aimed at creating a positive learning environment that nurtures students' intellectual growth.

Late Work / Extra Credit:

- All late work must be turned in within one week of when it was assigned. Students will receive 70% on late work turned in.
- Extra credit is not offered. However, during the last week of each quarter, students may turn in any missing or incomplete work for partial credit (60%).
- 10% will be taken off of project grades for late submissions.

COMMUNICATION:

The best way to communicate with a teacher is by email. Students will be sent home with a white envelope on Tuesdays that has updated work and various other documents regarding events at school.

Updates will also be sent out via Beehively, our electronic communication and grading portal. Announcements posted to Beehively are sent directly to your email, as well as important upcoming assignments and events.

MATERIALS:

- Composition Notebook (3)
- Pencils — colored and regular
- Red pen
- Highlighter
- HMH textbook
- Headphones, mouse

There will be times we do STEM projects that will require additional materials to be brought in, such as soda bottles, construction paper, balloons, etc.

CLASSROOM EXPECTATIONS:

- Students come to class prepared and ready to learn each day.
- Homework should be completed on time. If circumstances prevent completion, students should communicate with the teacher in advance so that an appropriate plan can be made.
- Everyone is encouraged to participate by asking questions, contributing ideas, and seeking clarification from the teacher when needed.
- We will treat ourselves, one another, and school property with respect and responsibility.

TEACHER CONTACT

- Contact me via email: jterry@starofthesea.org
- Please allow up to 24 hours for a response on school days.
- In-person office hours: 2:45–3:15 p.m. (M–F)

Empowered to Succeed, Guided by Faith